PassFrame tuition

Writing Technique

Year 5 Accelerated — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Worked examples — tutor talks through these first

Easy: What technique is used in "The old house sighed as the wind passed through its broken windows"?

Method & answer: Personification — the house is given the human action of sighing.

Standard: Which sentence is more sophisticated: "The forest was quiet and dark" or "An unnatural hush blanketed the forest, its shadows stretching like grasping fingers"?

Method & answer: The second — it combines personification ("hush blanketed") and a simile ("like grasping fingers") to build atmosphere, rather than using plain adjectives.

Advanced: Identify the techniques in: "Greed coiled around his heart like a serpent, hissing promises of gold."

Method & answer: Simile ("like a serpent") and personification (greed "coiled" and is "hissing") work together to make an abstract emotion feel physically threatening.

Easy / Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Which technique is used in "The old house sighed as the wind passed through its broken windows"? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

2. Explain the difference between a simile and a metaphor, using one example of each.

3. Identify the technique: "Seven slippery snakes slid silently through the sand."

4. Which sentence uses a simile rather than a metaphor? A) The fog was a thick grey blanket. B) The fog lay like a thick grey blanket. C) The fog smothered the valley. D) The fog crept over the hills.

5. Write a simile AND a metaphor to describe the same thing: a fierce dog.

6. What technique is used in "The engine spluttered, clunked and finally roared to life"? Explain its effect on the reader.

7. Identify the most powerful verb in this sentence and explain your choice: "She snatched the trophy and sprinted from the stage."

8. Which sentence is the clearest example of alliteration? A) Brave Ben bravely battled the beast. B) Ben was very brave indeed. C) The beast was large and scary. D) Ben fought the creature.

9. Select ALL the sentences that use personification: A) The sea devoured the shoreline. B) The waves were tall and powerful. C) Autumn painted the leaves gold and red. D) The weather changed quickly.

10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why, referring to technique: A) "The volcano erupted suddenly." B) "The volcano

11. Identify the technique and explain its effect: "Lightning cracked and sizzled across the sky."

12. Write a metaphor describing a determined athlete, then explain what it suggests about their character.

13. Which sentence opens with a fronted adverbial to create variety? A) After the storm passed, the village fell silent. B) The village fell silent after the storm passed. C) The storm passed and the village fell silent. D) The village, after the storm, fell silent.

14. Identify the technique used in this sentence, and explain why a writer might choose it over a plain description: "Despair wrapped itself around her heart."

15. Select ALL the phrases below that use a powerful, precise verb rather than a plain, overused one: A) trudged wearily B) went slowly

exploded, hurling molten rock into the blackened sky."

C) plummeted downwards D) fell down

Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Explain the difference between personification and an extended metaphor.

2. Which sentence contains an example of pathetic fallacy (weather reflecting mood)? A) The sun shone brightly on the happy picnic. B) The storm raged as her anger grew. C) It rained, so they went inside. D) The weather was cold and grey.

3. Identify the technique and explain its effect on the reader: "Curiosity nibbled at the edges of her mind."

4. Rewrite this flat sentence using a powerful verb and sensory detail: "The man walked into the room and sat down."

5. Which sentence shows, rather than tells, that a character is anxious, using more than one technique? A) Priya was anxious about the interview. B) Priya felt very nervous. C) Priya's stomach churned like a washing machine as she twisted her hands together. D) Priya was worried and scared.

6. Select ALL the sentences below that combine TWO techniques in one sentence: A) The thunder growled like an angry beast. B) The thunder was loud. C) The wind howled and clawed at the windows. D) The wind was strong.

7. Write a sentence that uses personification to describe a clock ticking away exam time, creating a sense of pressure.

8. Which technique is used in "Can you can a can as a canner can can a can?"? A) alliteration and onomatopoeia B) repetition and alliteration C) simile and metaphor D) personification and onomatopoeia

9. Explain why opening a paragraph with a short, sharp sentence ("She froze.") can be more effective than a longer descriptive sentence in the right context.

10. Choose the better-written sentence and explain why, using technical vocabulary: A) "The forest was quiet and dark." B) "An unnatural hush blanketed the forest, its shadows stretching like grasping fingers."

11. Identify TWO techniques combined in this sentence and explain their combined effect: "The relentless rain hammered and drummed against the roof like a thousand tiny fists."

12. Which sentence uses a fronted adverbial phrase (not a single adverb) to open? A) Without warning, the ground began to shake. B) Suddenly, the ground began to shake. C) The ground shook suddenly. D) It shook.

13. Select ALL the sentences below that use varied, non-subject-first openers: A) Beneath the floorboards, something scratched. B) Something scratched beneath the floorboards. C) Terrified, she backed away. D) She backed away, terrified.

14. Write a sentence that 'shows' a character feeling triumphant, using a powerful verb and one other technique.

15. Identify the technique and explain why the writer chose it over a literal description: "The exam papers glared up at her, daring her to fail."

Standard / Hard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. What is "pathetic fallacy" and how does it differ from personification more generally? Give an example.

6. Select ALL the techniques used in this sentence: "Greed coiled around his heart like a serpent, hissing promises of gold." A) simile B)

11. Select ALL the sentences below that use a powerful verb to imply character or emotion, not just action: A) She slammed the door. B)

personification C) metaphor D) onomatopoeia

She closed the door. C) He whispered the secret. D) He said the secret.

2. Which sentence best demonstrates an extended metaphor comparing school to a prison? A) School felt strict and boring sometimes. B) The bell was a warden's whistle, summoning inmates back to their cells for another lesson of confinement. C) School was like a prison. D) She didn't enjoy being at school.

7. Identify the technique and explain why it is a particularly sophisticated choice here: "The silence was a held breath, waiting to be released."

12. Identify the technique used in "Regret was a stone in his pocket, dragging him down with every step" and explain its layered effect.

3. Explain the effect of the powerful verb "wrenched" in: "He wrenched the door open against the howling wind."

8. Which sentence demonstrates the most sophisticated sentence variety? A) He was scared. He ran. He hid. B) Terrified, he sprinted away and hid, his heart hammering against his ribs. C) He was scared, so he ran and hid. D) Because he was scared, he ran and then he hid.

13. Which sentence uses onomatopoeia alongside personification to build atmosphere? A) The old pipes gurgled and groaned in protest. B) The pipes were old and noisy. C) He heard the pipes. D) The pipes needed replacing.

4. Rewrite this flat, 'telling' paragraph opener using at least two techniques: "It was a scary night. The house was old."

9. Explain why writers sometimes deliberately break sentence-length convention (e.g. using a one-word sentence like "Gone.") for effect.

14. Explain why combining alliteration, a powerful verb and personification makes this sentence particularly effective: "The merciless monsoon mauled the little village without mercy."

5. Which of these two extracts is more sophisticated, and why? A) "The city was busy at night with lots of lights and noise." B) "Neon signs bled colour into the rain-slicked streets, and the city's pulse quickened as night claimed its throne."

10. Write a short extended metaphor (two to three sentences) comparing grief to weather, and annotate it by labelling the technique used in each sentence.

15. Choose the more skilfully written paragraph opener and explain why, using at least three technical terms: A) "It was raining hard. The streets were empty. People stayed inside." B) "Rain hammered the deserted streets like a thousand impatient fists, and the city held its breath, waiting for the storm to pass."